PassFrame
TUITION

Journey to the Top of the World

Year 4 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Non-fiction (Geography)

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Mount Everest stands at 8,849 metres above sea level, making it the tallest mountain on Earth. Towering over the border between Nepal and Tibet, its peak is so high that the air there contains barely a third of the oxygen found at sea level.

For centuries, Everest was considered impossible to climb. Many expeditions attempted to reach the summit throughout the early twentieth century, but each one failed, often at great cost — several climbers lost their lives in the attempt.

That changed on 29th May 1953, when Edmund Hillary, a beekeeper from New Zealand, and Tenzing Norgay, a Sherpa mountaineer from Nepal, became the first people ever confirmed to reach the summit. The two men worked as a team throughout their final, gruelling climb, each relying completely on the other's skill and determination.

Conditions near the top of Everest are brutal. Temperatures can plunge far below freezing, winds howl at hurricane speed, and the lack of oxygen makes even simple movements exhausting. Climbers today often carry oxygen tanks to help them survive this extreme environment, known among mountaineers as the “death zone.”

Since Hillary and Tenzing's historic climb, thousands of people have successfully reached the summit of Everest. Yet the mountain remains one of the most dangerous places on Earth, and every attempt still demands enormous courage, skill and preparation.

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. In what year did Hillary and Tenzing reach the summit of Everest?

2. Where was Tenzing Norgay from?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you how much oxygen is found near the summit compared to sea level.

4. Underline the sentence that describes the weather conditions near the top of the mountain.

5. What does “plunge” suggest about how temperatures change near the summit?

6. Put these events in order: Hillary and Tenzing reach the summit / many early expeditions fail / thousands of people successfully climb Everest / climbers begin carrying oxygen tanks.

7. Why might the author have mentioned that several earlier climbers lost their lives?

8. What does the phrase “relying completely on the other's skill” suggest about Hillary and Tenzing's partnership?

9. Why do you think so few people managed to climb Everest before 1953?

10. What does the text suggest is needed for a successful attempt on Everest today?

11. Find and copy a word that means “extremely harsh or severe”, used to describe conditions near the summit.

12. Write one or two sentences giving your own opinion on what makes Hillary and Tenzing's achievement so remarkable.